

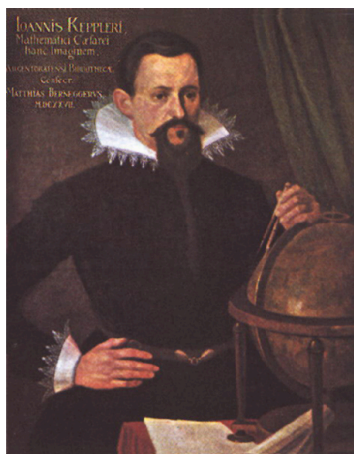
Tycho Brahe's Observatory

Three years after the publication of Copernicus' *De Revolutionibus*, Tycho **Brahe** was born to a family of Danish nobility. He developed an early interest in astronomy and, as a young man, made significant astronomical observations. Among these was a careful study of what we now know was an exploding star that flared up to great brilliance in the night sky. His growing reputation gained him the patronage of the Danish King Frederick II, and at the age of 30, Brahe was able to establish a fine astronomical observatory on the North Sea island of Hven ([Figure 1](#)). Brahe was the last and greatest of the pre-telescopic observers in Europe.

Tycho Brahe (1546–1601) and Johannes Kepler (1571–1630).



(a)



(b)

Figure 1. (a) A stylized engraving shows Tycho Brahe using his instruments to measure the altitude of celestial objects above the horizon. The large curved instrument in the foreground allowed